

MARCELO RONDON

PRODUCT DESIGNER, DESIGN SYSTEMS & AI TOOLS

🌐 Portland, Oregon 🌐

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ABOUT

Product designer focused on design systems and human-centered AI tools. I build and run what I design: deterministic code does everything it can, the model gets the smallest trustworthy job, and human approval sits where the consequences are. Recent work includes an in-house AI video pipeline that replaced 3–5 hours of manual work a week, Ghosted, an AI-assisted job-application product now in early testing, and Daybreak, a local-first Mac and iPhone planner with an auditable agent layer.

EXPERIENCE

Asheville Dispensary PRODUCT DESIGN LEAD / DESIGN ENGINEER

2022 – Present

Asheville, NC (Remote)

- Lead product and brand design for three brands (Asheville Dispensary, Plantbar, Nightshade) across web, print and packaging, anchored by a shared Figma design system.
- Built an automated product-to-social video pipeline that replaced 3–5 hours a week of manual design and editing: when a new flower drop is announced in Slack, an AI agent pulls each product's data, generates branded cards and vertical story videos, files them in Asana and queues them for social approval, with duplicate protection, quiet hours and a go-live check so nothing posts early.
- Cut an idle day's running cost from about \$12 to \$0.30: a script checks for new drops before any model starts, and a stronger model runs only when there's work, measured with a per-run usage report.
- Extending the approach across our design system: a print-coordination prototype with separate artwork, cost and release approvals; template-driven presentations and packaging compliance checks are planned.
- Designed and built an internal asset-management tool in React, TypeScript and Tailwind CSS that gives marketing and operations one place to find, manage and preserve brand assets.
- Design and ship reusable UI components into WordPress through custom PHP and JavaScript plugins, closing the gap between mockups and production.

VegAvengers Marketing PRODUCT DESIGNER / DESIGN ENGINEER

2025 – Present

Freelance project

- Designed and shipped the organization's content platform on Payload CMS: content model, editorial dashboard, and publish workflow, now run day-to-day by two non-technical editors.
- Built an AI freshness checker as Payload jobs that verifies festival data against primary sources and proposes corrections as drafts, so nothing goes live without editor approval.
- Designed and built the public discovery experience with flexible search across festivals and sanctuaries, served from the CMS with graceful fallbacks so an outage never breaks the site.

Cello.Design INDEPENDENT PRODUCT DESIGNER

2022 – Present

Independent product design and accessibility practice. Selected engagements:

- The Green Phial: redesigned and maintained the WordPress storefront, translating brand direction into responsive, accessible front-end implementation with improved performance and SEO.
- Accessibility consulting: improved WCAG 2.1 compliance for multiple organizations, including River Phoenix Center for Peacebuilding, covering screen-reader behavior, keyboard navigation, and performance.
- Legal Impact for Chickens: built secure internal tooling for data-management workflows, handling confidential materials with discretion.
- Ghosted: designed and built an AI-assisted job-application product across three versions, now in early testing.

Mantera Advertising Agency SENIOR BRAND DESIGNER

2021 – 2022

Remote

- Designed campaign and marketing materials for retail clients under tight deadlines.
- Worked directly with clients through fast iteration cycles, clarifying goals and constraints while protecting quality and delivery dates.

Success Academy Charter Schools
LEARNING EXPERIENCE DESIGNER / TEACHER

2020 – 2021

New York, NY (Remote)

- Designed remote learning experiences for ELA and math using structured learning frameworks.
- Produced educational content and visual aids, applying design thinking to improve comprehension and engagement.

The Fine Print Magazine
VISUAL STORYTELLING LEAD / PHOTO EDITOR

2017 – 2019

Gainesville, FL

- Led a team of photographers and directed visual coverage for editorial stories and events.
- Developed visual direction for fundraising events, using photography and design to improve visibility and engagement.

SKILLS

HTML CSS JAVASCRIPT TYPESCRIPT REACT TAILWIND GIT WORDPRESS PHP MYSQL FIGMA AI PRODUCT DESIGN
SWIFTUI / SWIFTDATA PHOTOSHOP ILLUSTRATOR AFTER EFFECTS PREMIERE PYTHON GO

PROJECTS

Ghosted

2026

An AI-assisted job-application workspace, designed and shipped across three versions and now in early testing.

- Designed and shipped Ghosted through three versions – a Go terminal prototype, a Next.js web app backed by 744 tests, and a 2026 rebuild around a live React + Typst resume canvas, built with a coding agent from my spec – now in early testing.
- Kept the model's job small and checkable: platform APIs, parsing and validation run in code first; the AI only drafts, and every resume change arrives as a versioned, highlighted edit the person accepts or rejects.
- Designed the agent to interview for evidence instead of inventing it: it asks for specifics, writes bullets only from what the person said, and names gaps against each posting.
- Designed job intake to read hiring-platform APIs first (Greenhouse, Lever, Ashby, Workday, Amazon, Microsoft) with Firecrawl only as a fallback, trimming postings to the role, requirements, pay and benefits.
- Run it as a hosted product for testers: personal-code accounts with server sync, an admin console, and in-app feedback with screenshots routed to Discord.

Daybreak

2026

Designed and built a local-first personal planning product for Mac and iPhone that combines a deterministic planning engine with agent-assisted adjustments while keeping the plan editable and the user in control.

- Shipped a shared SwiftUI and SwiftData app for macOS and iPhone with private CloudKit sync, without a product account or hosted application server
- Separated a pure, testable planning engine from the app layer so generated day plans obey explicit schedule, ownership, and local-day boundary rules
- Defined typed UI-agent parity contracts so agent-accessible actions match the product grammar, emit auditable receipts, and leave destructive or external actions behind explicit safety exclusions
- Kept automated planning inspectable and editable: people can review, move, defer, or remove Daybreak-owned blocks while source-owned calendar meetings remain protected
- Dogfooded the product against real planning and sync failures, turning trust problems into tested product rules across Mac and iPhone

EDUCATION

University of Florida
VISUAL JOURNALISM & COMMUNICATIONS

2016 – 2019

Minor: Digital Arts & Sciences